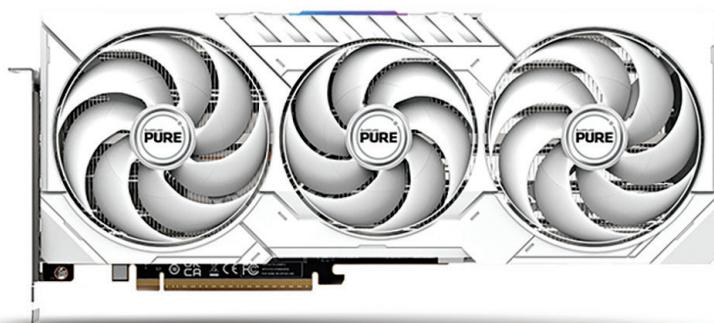


SAPPHIRE PURE AMD Radeon RX 9070 XT

It all comes down to local pricing

₹72,990

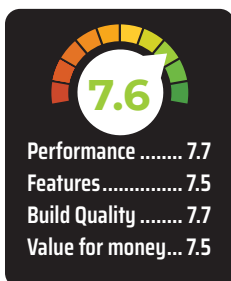


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ith the launch of the AMD Radeon RX

9070 XT, the company is going all out with their new RDNA 4 architecture with solid improvements to a lot of components aimed at not only increasing the raster performance but also AI performance. The company did state that it's more focused on producing graphics cards for the high-volume market segments rather than gunning for leadership in the top-of-the-line segment. That being said, AMD does appear to have a solid contender for the upper-mid range segment with the RX 9070 XT and they're going really aggressive with the pricing so as to not leave an inch of ground for the NVIDIA 5070 Ti and 5070 to tread on.

At a price point of USD 599, the AMD Radeon RX 9070 XT is not only undercutting the 5070 Ti but it also sets the stage for usurping market share for all the cards that will be positioned below it. We know that the Radeon RX 9060 XT and RX 9060 are next in line for launch but there's no telling when they'll hit the shelves. Moreover, declaring MSRP and actu-



ally selling the cards at MSRP are two completely different things, especially in India where retailers and wholesalers artificially inflate the prices. So will the Radeon RX 9070 XT sell for anywhere around INR 60,000-65,000? We're not quite certain they will but we'll know for sure in the coming days. AMD's victory lap might be short-lived if the dealers don't stick to MSRP pricing.

SPECIFICATIONS

The AMD Radeon RX 9070 XT, built using the latest RDNA 4 architecture which was unveiled at CES 2025, features 64 Compute Units with a grand total of 4096 Shaders. It also packs two dedicated AI cores per Compute Unit. There are several other modifications to the architecture geared towards making it more efficient than the previous gen RDNA 3. AMD claims that the RX 9070 XT can match and even outperform the RDNA 3 flagship 7900 XTX in quite a few benchmarks as a result. One of the biggest bumps is the clock speeds which are now touching 3 GHz!

The Radeon RX 9070 XT introduces a balance of efficiency and performance

improvements over its predecessor, the RX 7900 XTX, leveraging the RDNA 4 architecture. The RX 9070 XT features 16GB of GDDR6 memory with a 256-bit memory bus, while the RX 7900 XTX offers 24GB of GDDR6 memory with a wider 384-bit memory bus. This gives the RX 7900 XTX higher overall bandwidth, beneficial for workloads requiring high memory throughput. However, AMD has implemented improved memory compression in the RX 9070 XT, which helps mitigate the bandwidth deficit.

One of the major advantages of the RX 9070 XT is its improved power efficiency. The RX 9070 XT operates with a board power of 304W, significantly lower than the RX 7900 XTX's 355W. And it does so while introducing newer features such as the 3rd Gen Ray Tracing Accelerators, which promise twice the ray traversal efficiency compared to the 2nd Gen Ray Tracing Accelerators found in the RX 7900 XTX. A significant upgrade in the RX 9070 XT is the inclusion of 2nd Gen AI Accelerators, which bring substantial improvements in AI-driven workloads, such as upscaling and frame generation. The RX 7900 XTX lacks advanced AI acceleration to the same extent, meaning it may not fully leverage modern AI-powered upscaling technologies like AMD's FSR 4 to the same degree as the RX 9070 XT. The RX 9070 XT is an efficient and AI-ready alternative to the RX 7900 XTX. While it does not surpass its predecessor in pure rasterisation performance, it compensates with better ray tracing, improved AI acceleration, and superior power efficiency.

PERFORMANCE

It's interesting to see how the pair-ups of the AMD Radeon RX 9070 XT vs RTX 5070 vs RX 7900 XTX vs RTX 5070 Ti vs RTX 4080 Super vs RTX 5080 will pan out. For the full set of graphs, check out the review online. Here's how the 9070 XT pans out. In Synthetic benchmarks, the 9070 XT is at par with the RTX 4080 Super and does a little better than the RTX 5070 Ti. The RX 7900 XTX is a teensy bit ahead of the 9070 XT in DirectX 12 benchmarks and the gap